A GUIDE FOR TEACHERS

STOP THE SLOP

You're the boss.
AI is the team.

HOW TO USE AI WITHOUT HANDING OVER YOUR JUDGEMENT

PLAN · CHECK · DIAGNOSE · REPAIR · RE-CHECK · DECIDE

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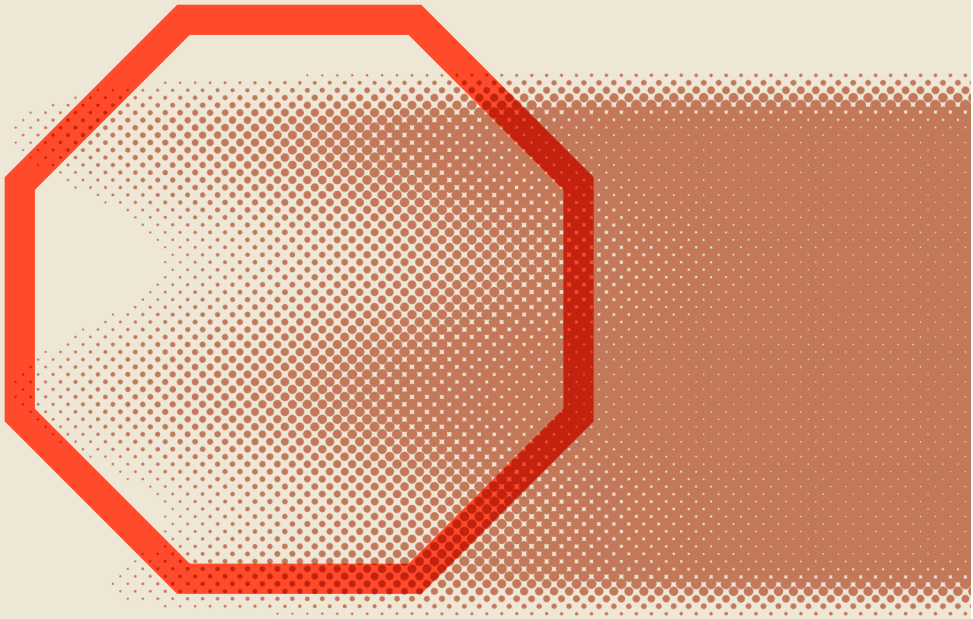
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START HERE

This guide is about making and checking teaching resources when AI has had a hand in them. It isn't trying to persuade you to use AI. If you do, it aims to keep you in charge of the result.

By **slop** it means output that hasn't been adequately examined, tested and improved for its intended use. Being made by AI doesn't define it: you can produce it yourself, and AI-assisted material can be carefully checked.

The method is: plan, check, diagnose, repair, re-check, decide.

It doesn't promise perfect resources, saved time, classroom success or an AI that can check itself. The prompts are untested suggestions, and no classroom trial is recorded for any example.

WHERE TO START

- **Unsure what to leave to AI, and what not to?** Chapter 1.
- **Want to spot weak material?** Chapter 2.
- **Starting a new resource?** Chapter 3.
- **Already have your own material?** Chapter 4.
- **Need to check a resource?** Chapter 5.
- **Found a problem?** Chapter 6.
- **PDF looks fine on screen?** Chapter 7.
- **Making the same mistakes again?** Chapter 8.
- **Want to see it all on one example?** Chapter 9.
- **About to paste something into an AI service?** Chapter 10.
- **Want a one-page checklist?** Appendix A.
- **Want to know the evidence limits?** Appendix B.



KEEP YOUR JUDGEMENT

There are two quite different ways to use AI.

AI REPLACING YOUR THINKING	AI HELPING WITH THE WORK AROUND YOUR THINKING
"Make me a worksheet on fractions."	"Here are my 20 fraction questions. Put them into a consistent format."
AI decides what students should do	You decide what students should do
You accept what comes back	You check what comes back against what you intended

This guide is about the right-hand column.

WHAT STAYS WITH YOU

Five decisions are yours, however much AI is involved:

- **Purpose:** what your students need and what the resource is for.
- **The task:** what students actually do, and whether it takes thought.
- **Level:** whether it suits your students, not an AI's idea of them.
- **Accuracy:** whether the facts and answers are right.
- **The final decision:** whether the finished resource is good enough to use.

WHERE AI CAN HELP

Around those decisions, AI can take on repetitive work: formatting and numbering your questions, producing variations of something you've made, tidying and proofreading, drafting an answer key from your answers, simplifying instructions, or pointing out where pages disagree. You choose what to hand over. Some teachers use it for brainstorming. Some never let it write a word of student material and use it only to format and proofread. Both are reasonable, and you don't have to use it for everything.

Whatever it does, you examine the result before you use it. Chapters 3 to 9 show how.

Before you paste anything into an AI service, read Chapter 10 on privacy, copyright and your school's rules.



RECOGNISE THE SLOP

Slop is output that hasn't been adequately examined, tested and improved for its intended use. It isn't defined by who or what made it. The signs below are reasons to look closer, not proof of a problem, and a resource you made yourself can show every one of them. The examples are illustrative.

SIGNS IN THE TASK

- **Nothing to decide.** Students could finish by copying, filling blanks or guessing, without making a choice.
- **No way in.** A student with only this page can't tell what to do, or the instructions refer to something that isn't on it. A worked example may even be one of the questions.
- **Level that drifts.** The vocabulary or thinking is well above or below your students, or changes partway through.

SIGNS BETWEEN THE PAGES

- **Pages that disagree.** Sheets give different names, numbers or situations. Matching versions (A and B, easier and harder) don't match.
- **Notes that don't fit the resource.** For example, the notes allow ten minutes for a "Task 3" on a two-task sheet, or timings that add up to more than the lesson.
- **An answer key that doesn't fit the task.** For example, "Answer: D" for a question with only three options, or a question with a second defensible answer.

SIGNS IN THE CONTENT

- **Suspicious facts.** Confident dates, figures, quotations or "did you know" facts with no source. A fluent sentence isn't evidence.
- **Filler.** Sections nobody would use in a lesson, or a vague setting that could be anywhere.
- **Leftovers.** Internal wording on a student page: placeholders, version labels, or part of the request that produced it.
- **The same oddity everywhere.** If one resource has a strange feature, check whether your earlier ones copied it from the same template.

SIGNS ON THE PAGE

- **Layout problems.** A heading stranded at the foot of a page, a nearly empty page, text cut off, or a page count that doesn't match your notes.
- **Answers where students can see them.** An answer on a student page, or in a preview or thumbnail.

WHAT THE SIGNS ARE NOT

Don't judge by how the writing sounds. Polished writing can sit on a broken task, and plain writing on a sound one. A resource with none of these signs may still not suit your class, which is why you test it.

Chapter 5 shows how to check, and Chapter 6 how to sort and repair what you find.



PLAN BEFORE YOU GENERATE

Planning first gives you a standard to check against (Chapters 5–7).

THE PLAN

Jot down a line for each.

- **Students finish by…** What do they decide, produce, solve or say at the end?
- **They can't do it without…** What information or thinking does the task need?
- **The tricky part is…** What makes it worth doing?
- **Who it's for:** age, level, subject, language needs.
- **How long:** a realistic time, with steps that add up.
- **Format:** how many pages, which are for students and which for you, black and white or colour, paper size.
- **The answers:** if the task has right answers, decide them now, before any material is written, so the key can't drift to fit the text.

You can do this alone. An AI can turn rough notes into these headings or suggest options, but whether it's a good activity for your students is your call.

THE LAZY-SHORTCUT TEST

Before you generate anything, ask what Chapter 5 asks of the finished pages: what is the quickest way a student could finish this without doing the thinking you intended? If the answer is copying, guessing or spotting a pattern, change the plan now. Add a decision, split the information or close the loophole.

WHAT A PLAN CHANGES

An illustration, not a result from the Lost Property case (Chapter 9).

Without a plan, a request such as "Make a lost-property speaking activity" may give you two sheets where students copy details from each other and nothing gets decided.

With one: “Five students say they lost something; four items are in the office. Pairs match items to owners using at least two details each. Two people claim the same item, and one person’s item isn’t there.” Now there is a real problem to talk through and a clear finish.

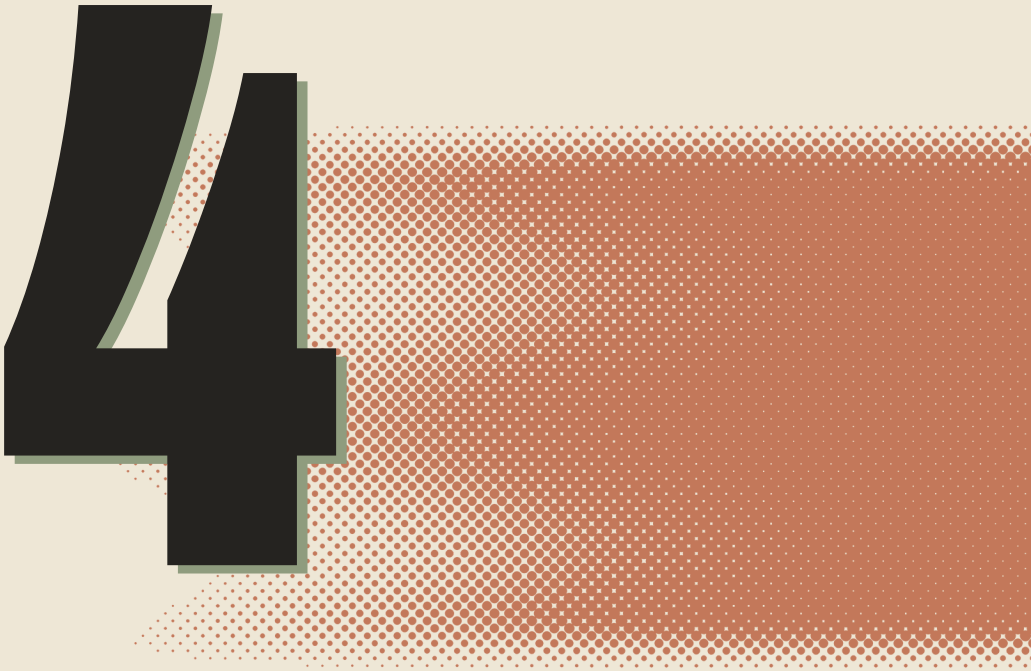
STRESS-TEST THE PLAN

You could try:

```
Here is my plan for a resource: [paste your plan]. Don’t write the
resource. Tell me: (1) the quickest way a student could finish
without the thinking I intended; (2) anything the task can’t be
done without that the plan doesn’t supply; (3) any steps whose
timings don’t add up; (4) any question where more than one answer
could be defended. List problems only; don’t fix them.
```

Untested suggestion. This wording hasn’t been tested and AI responses vary. It can miss problems or raise ones that aren’t there, so decide which are real.

Keep the plan with the resource. It tells you what the resource was meant to do, which helps you choose between repairing it and starting again (Chapter 6).



WORK FROM WHAT YOU ALREADY HAVE

The most useful thing you can give an AI is something you've already made: last year's worksheet, a lesson you've taught many times, a list of questions, rough notes. The teaching is then yours, and the AI is adapting it.

> **Instead of:** "Make a reading comprehension worksheet about volcanoes for Grade 6."
>
> **Try:** "Here's the volcano text I wrote and the eight questions I use with it. Keep my text and my questions. Make a second version for students who need more support, with a word bank and the first two answers started for them."

SAY WHAT MUST NOT CHANGE

Left to itself, an AI may "improve" things you wanted kept. Name them in each request: your wording, the answers, the numbering, the order, the level.

ASK FOR PROBLEMS BEFORE A REWRITE

Ask it to list what it thinks is wrong (errors only, or unclear instructions) without rewriting anything. Then you choose what changes. You keep the decisions, and you see what it noticed before anything moves.

ASK FOR VERSIONS, AND SEE WHAT CHANGED

When you want an easier and a harder version, ask it to show only what it changed, so you can see exactly what moved. You could try:

> Here is my activity: [paste it]. Make an easier version with a word bank and a harder version with no sentence starters. Keep the same answers, numbering and order of questions. Don't reprint the whole activity. For each version, show me only the lines you changed, with the original wording beside each one.

Untested suggestion. This wording hasn't been tested and AI responses vary. Its list of changes may be incomplete or wrong, so compare the versions yourself.

CHECK WHAT DEPENDS ON A CHANGE

A change in one place can leave other places out of step: the answer key, the teacher notes, a matching version. Chapter 6 shows how to check what depends on a change.

5

CHECK IT LIKE A USER

Before you repair anything, find out what's wrong. These checks ask you to use the resource the way someone else will: a student with one page, a teacher following your notes. None of them needs AI; most are careful reading.

There are two levels. The quick check is the minimum for anything you'll put in front of a class. The thorough check is for resources you'll share, reuse or build others from, or can't afford to get wrong. Neither has been timed or validated, so judge for yourself how long each takes.

THE QUICK CHECK

1. **Read each student page on its own.** Pretend it's the only page you've been given. Can you start? Do you know what you're meant to do, and is everything you need on this page?
2. **Do the task the lazy way.** Look for the quickest route to a finished sheet. If you can finish without the thinking you intended (copying, guessing, spotting a pattern), students can too. If copying or matching is the point, that's fine.
3. **Put the pages side by side.** Do the student sheets, notes and key agree about names, numbers, the situation and who holds what? Solve the answers yourself, then compare with the key: every question has an answer, every answer has a question, and the numbering matches. In one test resource, one student sheet described the partner's list as "items that people found", while the other sheet's table was headed "Lost items (what people reported)". That was one resource, so it shows what to look for, not how often it happens.
4. **Follow the teacher notes exactly as written.** Print what they say to print, use the page numbers they give, and see whether the timings add up. Then ask: could a colleague or supply teacher run this cold? Would they know what to print, how long it takes and where the answers are?
5. **Ask "who gets a copy of this page?"** Answers, teacher notes and worked examples shouldn't sit on a page students will receive. If a student page shows a worked example, make sure it isn't one of the questions they're meant to answer.

6. **Open the exported file and look at every page,** as your students will receive it. Chapter 7 covers this in detail.

Write down each problem with its page and line. Chapter 6 shows how to sort them and what to do next.

THE THOROUGH CHECK

Add these when the stakes are higher.

- **Facts.** Check anything you'd present as true (a date, a number, a "did you know") against a source you trust, and note when you checked if it might change. Solve answer keys yourself rather than trusting an AI-made one.
- **Ambiguity.** For each question, ask whether a second answer could be defended.
- **Level and age.** Judge the vocabulary and the thinking against your own students, not the AI's idea of a level. Mark words your weakest students wouldn't know, then pre-teach, replace or keep them.
- **Versions.** If there are matching versions (Student A and B, easier and harder), compare them for drift.

USING AN AI AS A SECOND PAIR OF EYES

An AI can read your pages and list suspected problems. That's useful, but it's another opinion, not verification. It can miss things, and it can report problems that aren't there. It can't see your printed page or know your students. Ask it to list problems, not fix them, and treat what it says as suggestions to check yourself. It may help to use a separate conversation from the one that made the resource; that's a reasoned suggestion, not something tested.

Three prompts you could try. Each does a different job.

> **Student-only read.** You are a [age] student. You have only the page below and no help from me. Tell me what you think you have to do, what confuses you, and whether you could finish. Then say what the quickest way to finish would be, even if it skips the thinking the task is meant to need. [paste one student page]
>
> **Fresh-eyes teacher review.** You are an experienced [subject] teacher seeing this resource for the first time. List problems only; don't rewrite anything. Think about the lesson: instructions that wouldn't work with a real class, timings that don't add up, anything a colleague would need that is missing, level problems, filler nobody would use. [paste student pages, teacher notes and answer key]
>
> **Facts, answers and consistency.** Here are the student pages, teacher notes and answer key. Change nothing. (1) Solve each question yourself first, then list any where your answer differs from the key or where more than one answer could be defended. (2) List every factual claim a teacher would present as true, so I can check them against sources; don't tell me they are correct. (3) List any differences between the pages in names, numbers, page references, timings or the situation described. [paste everything]

Untested suggestions. These wordings haven't been tested and AI responses vary. For the third prompt especially, check any "solved" answers yourself; a tool can say it has solved a question without doing so.

TEST YOUR CHECKS

A check that never finds anything may not be working. Before you trust "nothing found", try it on something you know is there: search a PDF for a word you can see on the page, or plant a deliberate mistake in a copy and see whether your check catches it.



DIAGNOSE AND REPAIR

You've spotted a problem in a resource an AI helped you make. The aim now is a small, checked repair, not another request to "make it better". Sometimes the right call is to bin the draft and start again from your plan.

SORT WHAT YOU'VE FOUND

Run the quick checks from Chapter 5, then sort each problem. **Cosmetic:** nobody would be misled. **Local:** one named place is wrong and you can say what right looks like. **Structural:** the task isn't doing what you wanted, or problems depend on each other. Local problems suit the method below; for structural ones, go back to your plan.

SYMPTOM FIRST, CAUSE SECOND

A symptom is what you notice. A cause is your best explanation, and it stays a hypothesis until you've checked; one symptom can have several.

For example: your notes say "keep page 4 for the answer key", but the key seems to be on page 6. Before changing anything: does the source still say page 4? Has the layout moved the key? Does the exported PDF match your editor? The cause could be the notes (written before the layout settled), the layout (a section grew) or the export settings. This symptom appeared in one test file, where the cause was not established.

SYMPTOM	POSSIBLE CAUSES (TO INVESTIGATE)	CONTROLLED REPAIR	RE-CHECK
Pages contradict each other	Pages may have been drafted separately, with no shared situation fixed	State the shared facts once; correct only the page that disagrees	Both student sheets, notes, key
Page references or page count don't match the file	Notes may predate the layout, or the layout may have changed since	Settle the layout, then correct the references; reflow if lines have spilled over	Each reference against the real page order

SYMPTOM	POSSIBLE CAUSES (TO INVESTIGATE)	CONTROLLED REPAIR	RE-CHECK
Students can finish without the thinking you intended (if copying or matching is the point, this is fine)	The task may need no decision, or one detail may give the answer away	No decision: return to your plan. A giveaway: change only that detail	Solve it as a student hunting for the quickest route
Answers appear on a page students will receive	Answers may share a page with student material, or a pattern may point to them	Move teacher material to its own page; remove the pattern	For each page: who gets a copy of this?
Answers remain findable in the file after being covered	A box may have been drawn over the text, hiding it without removing it	Rebuild the page without the answers	Search the exported file for a word from an answer; check any preview
A repair changed things you didn't ask for	The request may not have said what to keep	Say what must stay; ask what changed; undo unwanted changes	Compare old and new yourself
Wording sounds unnatural	The context may have been vague	Rewrite only the marked lines, saying who is speaking to whom	Read it aloud as the student would
Language is above or below your students' level	Your students' level may not have been stated, or the AI's idea of it may differ from yours	Replace or pre-teach the hard words; ask for simpler versions of those lines only	Read as a student; check key and notes still match
A fact may be wrong	Fluent text isn't evidence; the AI may have stated something false or out of date	Check a reliable source; correct or remove only that claim	Every other place the fact appears
Meaning depends on colour	The design may have assumed colour printing	Add a label, border or symbol	Print one page in black and white

If the same flaw keeps recurring across resources, see Chapter 8.

CONTROLLED REPAIR, STEP BY STEP

1. **Pin down the symptom:** page, line, what you saw.
2. **Investigate the likely cause:** list two or three possibilities and check the cheapest first. An AI's suggestions about causes are hypotheses too.
3. **Define what must not change:** a keep list of answers, numbering, page order, particular wording.
4. **Make the smallest appropriate repair:** one defect at a time. Sometimes editing by hand is quickest.
5. **Check the repair and its dependencies.** Before changing anything, note which of these it could touch, then check only those: the answer key; teacher instructions (steps, timings, page references); numbering; page count and order; information repeated elsewhere (names, times, quantities); matching versions (A/B, easier/harder). Compare old and new for changes you didn't ask for.
6. **Inspect the finished output.** Open the exported file itself and check its page order, references and text, and print a copy if you'll hand it out on paper. Chapter 7 covers how. Neither shows whether students will understand it.
7. **Decide:** retain, revise or discard.

If you ask an AI to make the change, you could try:

```
Here is [the page or text].
Problem: [what is wrong, and where].
Change only: [the material you permit, for example the page
references in the teacher notes]. Change nothing else.
Keep exactly as it is: [your keep list].
If you think the change affects anything else (the answer key,
say), tell me what and why, but don't change it unless I say so.
Then tell me what you changed.
```

Untested suggestion. This wording hasn't been tested and AI responses vary. The tool may still change what you told it to keep, and its account of its changes may be incomplete or wrong. Compare the actual versions yourself; don't rely on its report.

RETAIN, REVISE OR DISCARD

- **Retain** when the problem is fixed, the dependencies check out, the finished output looks right and you'd hand it to a colleague.
- **Revise** when a repair worked but exposed another local problem; carry on while each fix stays small and you can say what it touched.
- **Discard and restart** when repairs keep creating problems elsewhere, you can't say what the task now is, or the problem is structural. Keep the plan; the draft is the disposable part.

IN ONE TEST

One generic request ("check the whole activity for any problems… and fix them") was given to one AI model about one resource. It fixed the sheets' contradictory descriptions and rebalanced the blanks, with the key and notes updated to match. But its page references still didn't match the PDF made from it. The reply said it had tightened the spacing "so each student sheet fits on one A4 page", yet in that PDF each student sheet still ran onto a second page. It also said it couldn't preview the printout and advised a print preview. That was a generic request, not this method, and one test can't show how often such things happen. Chapter 9 gives the detail.

7

CHECK THE FINISHED FILE

A resource can look right in your editor and still go wrong in the file students receive. Chapter 5 asked whether it works and Chapter 6 how to repair it; this chapter is about the file itself.

THREE DIFFERENT CHECKS

- **On screen, in your editor or the AI's preview.** This shows what you made. It doesn't show what the exported file contains.
- **The exported PDF, opened on screen.** This shows the page count, order, breaks and text as exported. It doesn't show how a printer will reproduce it.
- **A physical print.** This shows margins, legibility, shading and double-sided behaviour on that printer. It doesn't show whether students will understand the task.

Each can catch problems the others can't, and none stands in for the others. In one test, an AI reply said it had tightened the spacing "so each student sheet fits on one A4 page", yet the exported PDF still ran each sheet onto a second page: the "Task 3" heading sat at the foot of the first page, with its question alone on the second. That file was examined on screen, partly through its extracted text and page layout, not by viewing alone. No physical print of any test file is recorded.

EXPORT, THEN OPEN THE FILE

1. **Export to the format and paper size you'll actually use.** Check the page size rather than assuming it.
2. **Open the exported file itself,** not the document it came from and not the AI's description of it. Count the pages.
3. **Re-export after every change.** A fix is a new version.

LOOK AT EVERY PAGE

- **Page count, order and content** match your plan and notes: every page, table and image you expected is there.

- **Overflow and breaks.** Look for anything cut off, overlapping or off the edge, pages holding only a line or two, and headings left at the foot of a page with their text on the next.
- **Leftovers.** “TODO”, “draft”, file names, version numbers, prompt text in an image. Search for them, having first tested your search (Chapter 5).
- **The right things on the right pages.** Student pages carry no answers, and the teacher notes and key aren’t on a page students will receive. Check the page references in your notes against this file.
- **Real text.** Select and search for a word you can see. Looking at a page doesn’t tell you what text sits under it.
- **Hidden isn’t removed.** If an answer was covered with a box, the text may still be in the file. Search the exported file for a word from an answer. The same goes for previews and thumbnails you share: check the preview file itself, not the original.
- **Images.** Zoom in: stray lettering or odd details are easier to see at full size.

READABILITY AND CONTRAST

Read the page at the size it will be printed. Light grey text, pale tints and small print can vanish on paper. Don’t let colour alone carry meaning; add a label, border or symbol.

PRINTING

If you print the resource, print one copy on the printer you’ll use, in black and white if that’s normal for you. Check that shading and small text are still legible, that nothing is clipped at the margins, and what’s on the back of each sheet if you print double-sided. For paired sheets such as Student A and Student B, make sure the back of one doesn’t carry the other, or print single-sided. If you haven’t printed it, know what you have and haven’t checked.

AFTER A REPAIR

Export again and look at the whole file, not just the page you changed. A change can move text onto a new page, shift page numbers or break a reference. Check the page count, order and references again, then use the decision in Chapter 6: retain, revise or discard.



MAKE QUALITY REPEATABLE

Checking one resource well is useful. Not having to rediscover the same mistake in the next resource is better. This chapter is about turning what you find into a few habits that last.

KEEP A MISTAKES LOG

When a check or a repair turns up a problem, add one line to a running list: what went wrong, then the rule that would have prevented it.

MISTAKE	RULE
Teacher notes said “print pages 1 and 2” but the student sheets were on pages 1 and 3	Check every page reference against the exported file
An answer was covered by a box but still searchable *(illustrative example of general guidance, not an incident from the test)*	Search the exported file for an answer word before sharing
(your own example)	*(your own rule)*

Keep the rules short and in your own words. After a few resources, the same rules will keep appearing. Those are the ones to build into your routine.

In one test, the page-reference mismatch in the first row was still there after a single generic follow-up request. A mistake that survives one repair is worth a rule.

TURN THE LOG INTO A CHECKLIST

Take the rules that recur and make them your own checklist, one line each. The quick check in Chapter 5 is a starting point. Add your recurring rules and remove any you never need. A checklist of five lines you use beats one of twenty you don’t.

WRITE A STYLE SHEET

If you make several resources, write a short list of what yours should and shouldn’t look and sound like. For example: “UK English, ‘Year 7’ not ‘grade 7’; real-world settings; no mascots; no filler ‘fun facts’; plain, friendly instructions; same names for the same things on every page.” Give it to the AI at the start of a task. It helps keep your materials consistent, but you still check the result against it.

REUSE A TEMPLATE WITHOUT COPYING ITS FLAW

A template is a shortcut, and it also copies whatever is wrong with it into every resource you make from it. Before reusing one:

1. **Re-check the template itself** as if it were a new resource, including the exported file.
2. **Change the content, then check what depends on it.** Titles, names, page references, answers and counts are the usual things left behind from the last use.
3. **Search for leftovers** from the previous topic (Chapter 7).
4. **If you find a flaw, fix the template,** not just the copy in front of you, and add a line to your log.

9

CASE STUDY: LOST PROPERTY

This chapter follows one small test from request to repair. It shows what the checks in Chapters 5–7 and the method in Chapter 6 are for. It is one sample, so treat it as an illustration and not as evidence of how often any of this happens.

THE REQUEST

The test used this request, written to stand for ordinary use:

> I teach ESL to middle school students (around B1 level). Can you make me a printable information gap speaking activity about a lost property office? I need a Student A sheet, a Student B sheet, short teacher instructions and an answer key. It should take about 20 minutes. Please make it look nice and give it to me as one HTML file I can print to PDF.

A Claude Sonnet-family model answered it as an ordinary chat assistant would, with no research or checking. The exact model version wasn't recorded. The HTML was printed to PDF with no edits. The record describes the printing as "US Letter, default margins", but the first output's HTML sets A4 and both PDFs are A4. The request named no paper size, and the discrepancy is unresolved (see Appendix B).

The example is ESL material, but the checks apply to any subject.

WHAT CAME BACK

Six pages: Student A, then a page holding only Task 3, then Student B, another Task 3 page, the teacher notes and the key. Reading it as a user (Chapter 5) found:

- **The sheets contradicted each other.** Student A's sheet said the partner held the list of items people *found*. Student B's said the partner held a list of things people *lost*. Both tables were headed "Lost items (what people reported)".
- **The teacher notes didn't match the file.** They said to print pages 1 and 2 separately and keep page 4 as the answer key. In the file, Student B was on page 3 and the key on page 6.

- **The workload was uneven.** Student A had seven blanks to fill and Student B eleven.

Nothing here depends on the text being machine-made. A person could have written the same contradiction. It is slop in this book's sense because nobody had yet examined it for use.

ONE ORDINARY FOLLOW-UP

A fresh model instance was given only the output and this message:

> Thanks! Before I print this for my class, can you check the whole activity for any problems (anything confusing, wrong, or that wouldn't work in a real classroom or when printed) and fix them? Give me the improved version as one HTML file.

The reply listed ten fixes. Comparing the new file with the claims:

	THE REPLY'S CLAIM OR ADVICE	WHAT THE EXPORTED FILE SHOWED
Fixed	"Both sheets now say you each have the same list of six reports, with different gaps"	Both sheets now describe the same list, with different gaps
Fixed	"I rebalanced the list so each student has 9"	Nine blanks each, up from seven and eleven. The key's bold cells rose from seven to nine, and the teacher note now says "9 missing pieces of information per student"
Not fixed	"It now says to keep pages 3 and 4 and not hand them out"	The revised notes said "print pages 1 and 2, one sheet per student… Keep pages 3 and 4 (teacher instructions and answer key)". In the exported file, page 3 contains Student B and page 4 contains only Task 3. The teacher notes are on page 5 and the key on page 6. So the references still did not match the six-page PDF. Assessment, not a separate observation: this is arguably worse than the original note ("Keep page 4 (answer key)"), because it now describes Student B's page as teacher material

	THE REPLY'S CLAIM OR ADVICE	WHAT THE EXPORTED FILE SHOWED
Claim not borne out	"I tightened the spacing and font sizes so each student sheet fits on one A4 page"	Still six pages. The "Task 3" heading sat at the foot of pages 1 and 3, with its question alone on pages 2 and 4, so each student's sheet still ran onto a second page
Advice, not a file finding	"I could not preview the printout here, so please do a quick print preview before you copy the pages for your class"	The reply was accurate about its limit. The file itself can't show whether printing will work, and no print of it is recorded

WHAT THIS SHOWS

- **In this test, a broad request produced a broad reply.** "Check the whole activity" returned a list of confident changes. Some were real. Others weren't borne out, and the reply didn't separate them.
- **A repair can change a reference without checking it.** In this test, the blank rebalance updated its dependents (key and count), but the page-reference fix didn't. That is the dependency list from Chapter 6.
- **A claim about the file isn't a check of the file.** Only opening the exported PDF showed the sheets still ran over. This is Chapter 7.
- **The reply was accurate about its limit.** It couldn't print, so someone else had to.

A controlled repair of the page-reference problem would follow the sequence in Chapter 6. That was not tried here, so how it would have performed is untested.

WHAT THIS CAN'T TELL YOU

It is one resource, one model family and one request, with an AI-written prompt. Whether the files look right on paper hasn't been established: no physical print of them is recorded, and no use with students is recorded. The shading that marks which items a student holds was a very pale tint in the first file, and a darker grey in the second as viewed on screen. How either prints is untested.

10

RESPONSIBLE USE

The rules depend on your country, your school and the AI service. This chapter points to what to check. It isn't legal advice.

PUPIL INFORMATION

Department for Education (DfE) guidance for schools and colleges in England, updated 12 August 2025, recommends that personal data is not used in generative AI tools. Don't paste identifiable pupil information or other sensitive material into a general AI service unless you've checked that it's permitted.

PUPILS' WORK

The same guidance says schools must not allow pupils' original work to be used to train AI models without permission, or an applicable exception to copyright. It notes that some free tools use what you enter for training, and that some paid tools let you opt out.

THE SERVICE'S TERMS AND YOUR SCHOOL'S POLICY

Check the AI service's current terms on keeping your data and training its models. That is practical advice, not something the guidance states. Check your school's or employer's policy too, and ask if it isn't clear.

COPYRIGHT AND OWNERSHIP

This depends on where you are. In the United States, the Copyright Office concluded in January 2025 that prompts alone are unlikely to make you the author of AI output, while human selection, arrangement or modification can be protected. That is US analysis, not UK law. In March 2026 the UK government proposed removing protection for wholly computer-generated works while keeping it for works made with AI assistance; that is a proposal, not a change in the law.

So don't assume you own, or can sell, what an AI produces. Check the rules where you live and the licence on anything you feed in.

FACTS AND SUITABILITY

DfE says AI content needs critical judgement to check its appropriateness and accuracy, and that the professional remains responsible for the final document. Check facts, answers and suitability yourself (Chapter 5).

ACCESSIBILITY

Don't let colour be the only signal, and make sure text has enough contrast (Chapter 7). WCAG 2.2 is a web-content standard that states the colour principle. It doesn't govern printed worksheets, and borrowing its ideas doesn't make a resource compliant.

Sources are listed under "Sources (Chapter 10)" at the end of the book.

APPENDIX



CHECKLIST

Tick what you have checked, not what you assume. Neither check has been timed or validated, and neither guarantees quality.

QUICK CHECK

- ☐ Each student page, read on its own: can you start, and is everything you need there?
- ☐ The task done the lazy way: can you finish without the thinking you intended?
- ☐ Pages side by side: names, numbers, situation and who holds what agree.
- ☐ Answers solved yourself and compared with the key; numbering matches.
- ☐ Teacher notes followed exactly: what to print, page numbers, timings.
- ☐ Each page: who gets a copy? No answers or teacher notes on student pages.
- ☐ Exported file opened and every page looked at.

THOROUGH CHECK

- ☐ Student instructions: could a student start without you?
- ☐ The task needs the intended thinking, not just copying or guessing (unless that is the point).
- ☐ Sheets, notes and key agree; matching versions (A/B, easier/harder) have not drifted.
- ☐ Facts checked against a source you trust, with the date noted if it may change.
- ☐ Each question: could a second answer be defended?
- ☐ Level and age judged against your own students; hard words pre-taught, replaced or kept.
- ☐ Page order, page breaks and page references checked in the exported PDF.

MY OWN RECURRING CHECKS

- ☐ _____

APPENDIX



EVIDENCE NOTES AND LIMITS

WHAT WAS TESTED

One request for one resource (a lost property information-gap activity), then one generic follow-up asking for checks and fixes. The files are the first output, the revised output and the follow-up reply. One case cannot show how AI generally behaves or how often any defect occurs.

HOW IT WAS PRODUCED

Each version came from a fresh instance of a Sonnet-family model, run as a sub-agent. The exact model version was not recorded. The request and the project's own assessments were written by AI. For the first output, RAW_PROMPT.md describes the permitted printing setup as "US Letter, default margins", but the HTML specifies A4 and both PDFs are A4. The discrepancy is unresolved: the record does not show which print settings were actually used.

WHAT THE FILES SHOW

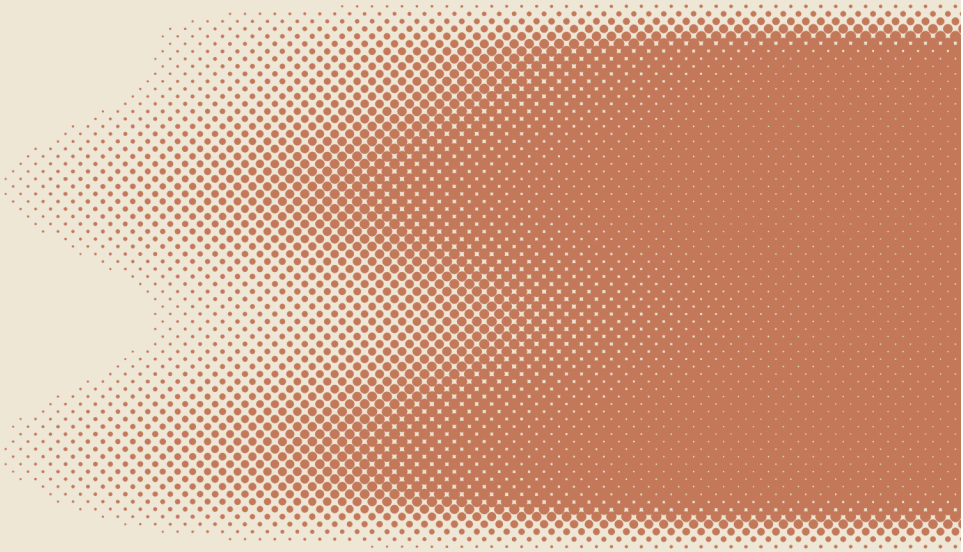
The first output ran to six pages. The two student sheets described the partner's list differently, the teacher notes' page references did not match the file, and the blank counts were uneven (7 and 11). After the follow-up, the descriptions agreed and the blanks were 9 and 9. The page references still did not match, and each student sheet still ran onto a second page, although the reply said it would fit on one.

WHAT IS MISSING

No physical print and no classroom use are recorded. No human check of the case-study findings is recorded. That is separate from the author's review and correction of parts of the guide (see below).

AI-USE NOTE

AI tools were used extensively in developing this guide, including drafting and revising text, generating teaching-resource examples, and analysing the outputs produced during the case study. The Lost Property case study documents an AI-run process; the available records do not establish that the resulting materials were physically printed or used with students. The exact model version used in the case study was not recorded. The author made editorial decisions and reviewed and corrected parts of the guide during development.



SOURCES (CHAPTER 10)

- Department for Education (England), *Generative artificial intelligence (AI) in education*, guidance, updated 12 August 2025. https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/generative-artificial-intelligence-in-education
- US Copyright Office, *Copyright and Artificial Intelligence, Part 2: Copyrightability*, January 2025. https://www.copyright.gov/ai/Copyright-and-Artificial-Intelligence-Part-2-Copyrightability-Report.pdf
- UK Government (DSIT and DCMS), *Report on Copyright and Artificial Intelligence*, published 18 March 2026. https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/report-and-impact-assessment-on-copyright-and-artificial-intelligence
- W3C, *Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2*, W3C Recommendation, 12 December 2024. https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG22/